

Reference: 1-246847147

Date: 11 December 2013

Address: Nige Coleman
request-184767-cf50e246@whatdotheyknow.com

Julia Snape
Information Requests

information.requests@ofcom.org.uk

Dear Mr Coleman

Freedom of Information: Right to know request

Thank you for your request for information regarding licence figures which we received on 13 November 2013 and have considered under the Freedom of Information Act 2000 (the Act).

You asked:

Please would you be kind enough to provide the annual number of licences held (any class) for both the amateur radio service and for business radio, for each year starting 1993, to date.

I am writing to confirm that Ofcom has now completed its search. We are able to provide information from 2003, the date of Ofcom's inception. The below tables provide statistical data for licences issued in the Amateur Radio and Private Mobile (Business) Radio services.

1 April 2003 - 31 March 2004	
Product	Total
Amateur Radio	29190
Business Radio	6371

1 April 2004 - 31 March 2005	
Product	Total
Amateur Radio	167561
Business Radio	6515

1 April 2005 - 31 March 2006	
Product	Total
Amateur Radio	157256
Business Radio	6266

1 April 2006 - 31 March 2007	
Product	Total
Amateur Radio	59102
Business Radio	7058

1 April 2007 - 31 March 2008	
Product	Total
Amateur Radio	27443
Business Radio	5981

1 April 2008 - 31 March 2009	
Product	Total
Amateur Radio	20155
Business Radio	4882

1 April 2009 - 31 March 2010	
Product	Total
Amateur Radio	25154
Business Radio	4488

1 April 2010 - 31 March 2011	
Product	Total
Amateur Radio	24487
Business Radio	4890

1 April 2011 - 31 March 2012	
Product	Total
Amateur Radio	24409
Business Radio	4954

1 April 2012 - 31 March 2013	
Product	Total
Amateur Radio	28041
Business Radio	4738

As regards information pre-dating 2003, we can neither confirm nor deny that we hold information relating to this in our archives. The information is not readily accessible and a considerable amount of time would be needed to locate, retrieve, identify and extract any relevant information. This would involve a manual search of any records. Section 12 of the Freedom of Information Act 2000 provides that a public authority is not obliged to comply with a request for information if the authority estimates that the cost of complying with the request would exceed the “appropriate limit”. The appropriate limit is set out in the Freedom of Information and Data Protection (Appropriate Limit and Fees) Regulations 2004, and is, for Ofcom, £450. That sum is intended to cover the estimated costs involved in determining whether Ofcom holds the information requested, identifying, locating, retrieving and extracting the information from any document containing it. The Regulations provide that costs are to be estimated at a rate of £25 per person per hour.

Ofcom estimates that it would take more than 18 hours to identify, locate and extract information pre-dating 2003, and as such the cost of complying with this part of your request will exceed the appropriate limit. We will therefore not be able to provide any information in relation to the period 1993 to 2003.

However, as we have been able to supply information from 2003 to 2013, I hope that this satisfies your enquiries. Please quote the reference number above in any future correspondence as this will help us to deal with your query more quickly.

Yours sincerely

Julia Snape

If you are unhappy with the response or level of service you have received in relation to your request from Ofcom, you may ask for an internal review. If you ask us for an internal review of our decision, it will be treated as a formal complaint and will be subject to an independent review within Ofcom. We will acknowledge the complaint and inform you of the date by which you might expect to be told the outcome.

The following outcomes are possible:

- the original decision is upheld; or
- the original decision is reversed or modified.

Timing

If you wish to exercise your right to an internal review **you should contact us within two months of the date of this letter**. There is no statutory deadline for undertaking internal reviews and it will depend upon the complexity of the case. However, we aim to conclude all such reviews within 20 working days, and up to 40 working days in exceptional cases. We will keep you informed of the progress of any such review. If you wish to request an internal review, you should contact:

Graham Howell
The Secretary to the Corporation
Ofcom
Riverside House
2a Southwark Bridge Road
London SE1 9HA

If you are not content with the outcome of the internal review, you have the right to apply directly to the Information Commissioner for a decision. The Information Commissioner can be contacted at:

Information Commissioner's Office
Wycliffe House
Water Lane

Wilmslow
Cheshire
SK9 5AF